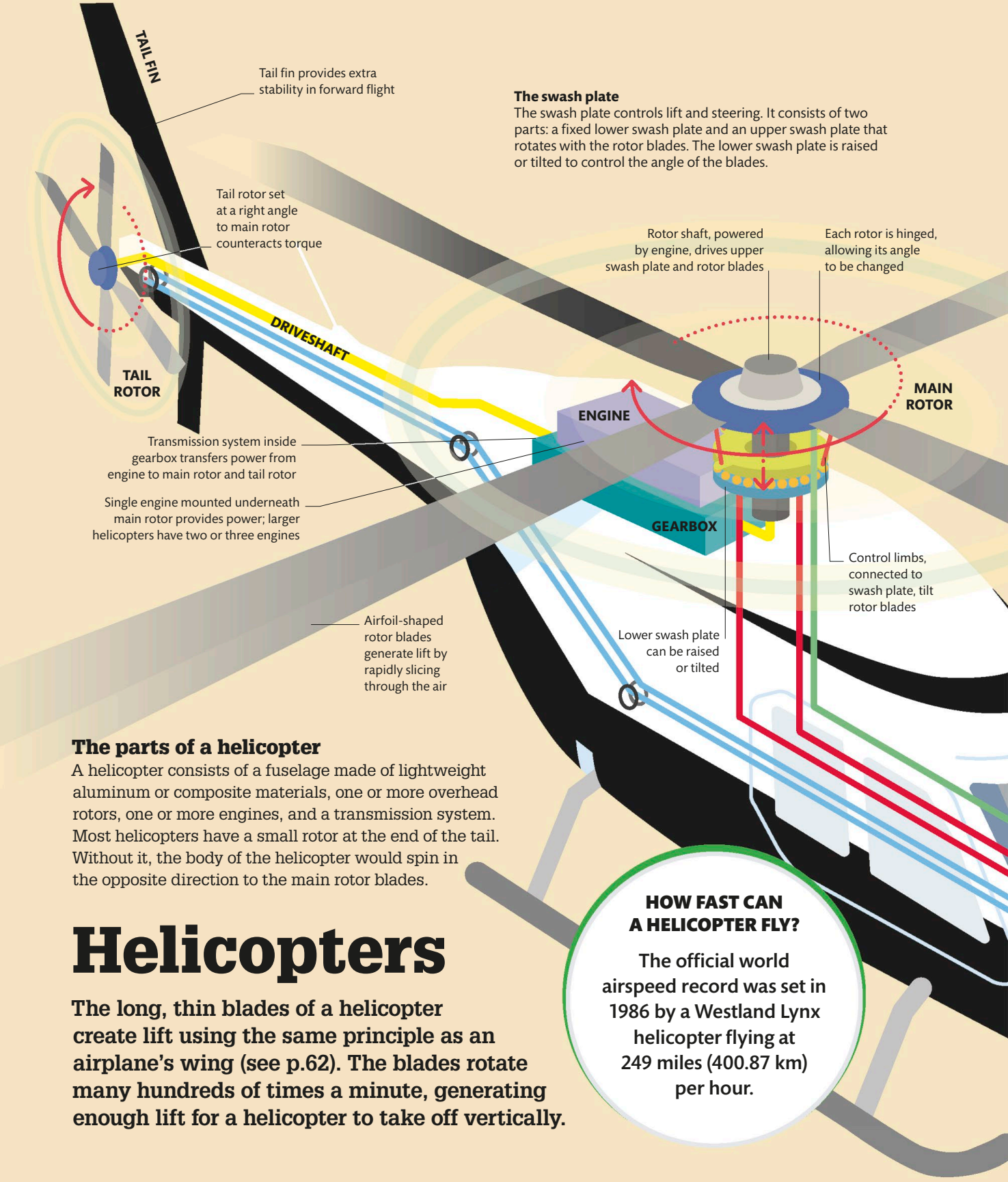


The swash plate
The swash plate controls lift and steering. It consists of two parts: a fixed lower swash plate and an upper swash plate that rotates with the rotor blades. The lower swash plate is raised or tilted to control the angle of the blades.

The parts of a helicopter

A helicopter consists of a fuselage made of lightweight aluminum or composite materials, one or more overhead rotors, one or more engines, and a transmission system. Most helicopters have a small rotor at the end of the tail. Without it, the body of the helicopter would spin in the opposite direction to the main rotor blades.

Helicopters

The long, thin blades of a helicopter create lift using the same principle as an airplane's wing (see p.62). The blades rotate many hundreds of times a minute, generating enough lift for a helicopter to take off vertically.

HOW FAST CAN A HELICOPTER FLY?

The official world airspeed record was set in 1986 by a Westland Lynx helicopter flying at 249 miles (400.87 km) per hour.